Global Affairs Policy

The Green Party supports an international rules-based order that protects and restores the environment, upholds fundamental human rights and international justice, and acts in unison in a responsible and non-violent manner to support peace globally.

Vision

Aotearoa New Zealand takes independent, principled stances on the global stage to cooperatively uphold the rights and interests of all and our planet, now and in the future.

Values and Principles

Aotearoa New Zealand's work with other countries and overseas organisations must be consistent with the following values and principles:

- *Honour Te Tiriti o Waitangi*: Aotearoa New Zealand's global relations should uphold the articles of Te Tiriti and support all indigenous peoples and their global movements, including movements to return land dispossessed by colonisation.
- *Ecological Wisdom*: The global ecological foundations that sustain life must be urgently protected and restored and be at the heart of our relations with the rest of the world.
- *Social Responsibility*: Global equity and justice are foundations for the security, prosperity, and resilience of all countries. The international system must act collectively to meet the diverse needs of communities, while advancing the common interests of people everywhere. While all countries share a common obligation to address global challenges, their responsibilities differ based on their historical contribution and capacity to act.
- *Appropriate Decision-Making*: International rule of law, and fair, impartial and transparent national and international institutions based in law, are key mechanisms to address global challenges. The self-determination of peoples is an essential step in the attainment of universal peace.
- *Non-Violence*: A world without violence is possible. Meaningful, rapid cooperation among all states and other international communities is required to peacefully and successfully resolve conflicts and global challenges.
- *Complexity*: The interconnected nature of global challenges and their systemic causes requires a sustained, dynamic approach that includes overseas and international organisations.
- *Integrity:* Criticism of any foreign state or overseas organisation by Aotearoa New Zealand for violation of these principles should never be muted in the name of narrow economic or political interests, or historic affiliations.

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Strategic Priorities

"We recognise:

- *The unprecedented scale and urgency of the ecological crises facing our nation and our planet.*
- *The large and growing scale of local and global inequalities and their role in the ecological crises we face."*

Actions in this policy that help address these issues include:

- Working cooperatively, generously, and respectfully with other countries to address global challenges, taking an enabling approach to support countries that have less capability to contribute to solving global problems (3.1)
- Advocating for international cooperation and coordination on:
    - Strengthening international agreements for managing, restoring, and enhancing the ecological health of the global commons, including climate, high seas, air, and globally significant ecological assets, including biodiversity (1.1.1)
    - Establishing Ecocide as a crime under the Rome Statute of the International Criminal Court (1.1.2)
    - Coordinating rapid international phase-out of practices and substances that threaten the ongoing viability of humanity and other species (...) (1.1.3)
    - Pursuing conflict prevention and peaceful resolution of international conflict, including diplomatic efforts to address conflicts before they escalate and facilitating peace mediation between states and/or non-state actors (2.5.1)
    - New international agreements that protect the rights of as yet unprotected marginalised groups (2.1.2)
    - Cancelling unjust debt and providing unconditional debt relief that alleviates global inequality (3.1.3)

Connected Policies

Connected internationally-oriented policies outline our approach to appropriate and ethical Trade and Foreign Investment, non-violent Security and Defence, and compassionate Immigration. Several other policies support the domestic implementation of international agreements, including those related to Climate Change, Biodiversity and Environmental Regeneration, the Marine environment, Human Rights, Animal Welfare, Digital technologies, and Education.

Policy Positions

1. Environmental Protection and Restoration

Issues

Critical Earth system processes that regulate the planet's stability and resilience are being undermined. Safe limits have been breached in climate systems, biodiversity loss, land-use change, synthetic substances, nitrogen and phosphorus cycles, freshwater change, and ocean acidification, signaling increasing environmental risks and potential irreversible changes. These systems are interdependent, meaning breaching one affects others.

Actions

1.1. Advocate for international cooperation and coordination that mitigates global environmental risks, including:

1.1.1. Strengthening international agreements for managing, restoring, and enhancing the ecological health of the global commons, including climate, high seas, air, and globally significant ecological assets, including biodiversity;

1.1.2. Establishing Ecocide as a crime under the Rome Statute of the International Criminal Court (ICC);

1.1.3. Coordinating rapid international phase-out of practices and substances that threaten the ongoing viability of humanity and other species by, for example, unbalancing the nitrogen, carbon, and water cycles, depleting the ozone layer, degrading natural ecosystems with high endemic biodiversity and/or endangered species, and destroying biological soil systems on large scales;

1.1.4. Formal recognition, by all states, of the global ecological crises and their impacts on human social, cultural, and economic wellbeing, and formal commitments to refining their domestic policies accordingly;

1.1.5. A renewed focus on addressing the high per capita ecological footprint and consumption of developed countries and the global economic practices that support it; and

1.1.6. Improving access to information, public participation in decision-making, and access to justice, in relation to global environmental issues.

1.2. Support and financially contribute to international programmes that aim to stabilise our climate and protect and restore the health of land, freshwater and marine ecosystems, including tree planting programmes.

1.3. Encourage and support a two-way sharing of ideas and successes for sustainable living between Aotearoa New Zealand and other countries, and between our cities and towns and their 'twin cities' and 'twin villages' in other countries.

2. Wellbeing, Equity, and Non-Violence

Issues

Worsening trends in global human rights are being shaped by violations of international humanitarian law during armed conflict, repression of dissent, discrimination, economic and environmental injustices, and the misuse of technology.

Actions

2.1. Advocate for international cooperation and coordination that supports international justice and equity, including:

2.1.1. All states ratifying and implementing international agreements that are aligned with the Universal Declaration of Human Rights;

2.1.2. New international agreements that protect the rights of as yet unprotected marginalised groups; and

2.1.3. Universal access to quality education and voluntary family planning services

2.2. Lead global action to remedy the injustices and human rights violations caused by climate change and other disruptions to global ecological systems by human activity, including mass forced migration.

2.3. Increase humanitarian aid for developing nations to deal with energy disruptions and climate-related disasters

2.4. Oppose any counter-terrorism practice conducted in violation of human rights law, including by:

2.4.1. Opposing the practices of extraordinary rendition, indefinite and arbitrary detention, and collective punishment (such as house demolition and land defilement); and

2.4.2. Insisting that any terrorist suspects be subject to the normal judicial process.

2.5. Advocate for international cooperation and coordination that supports peace and non-violence, including:

2.5.1. Pursuing conflict prevention and peaceful resolution of international conflict, including diplomatic efforts to address conflicts before they escalate and facilitating peace mediation between states and/or non-state actors;

2.5.2. Addressing, through positive economic, social and political policies, the legitimate economic and social grievances felt by many groups that foster non-state terrorism;

2.5.3. Completing and universally ratifying treaties banning the manufacture, sale, and use of inhumane weapons;

2.5.4. Strictly regulating and requiring transparency from the global arms industry; and

2.5.5. Global denuclearisation, including all states ratifying the United Nations Treaty on the Prohibition of Nuclear Weapons.

2.6. Oppose violent responses to international conflict, in the interests of minimising violence at a global scale, by:

2.6.1. Ratifying the ‘crime of aggression’ under the Rome Statute of the ICC;

2.6.2. Applying the doctrine of 'responsibility to protect' in cases of state-sanctioned genocide or gross and systematic violations of human rights, having regard to the need to ensure that any UN-authorised intervention is designed exclusively to meet the needs of the victim population and that the decision to intervene does not reflect the primacy of any major power interests;

2.6.3. Condemning terrorism by both states and by non-state actors, recognising that they equally visit death and destruction upon innocent people; and

2.6.4. Opposing military intervention and occupation, recognising that this increases rather than diminishes terrorism.

2.7. Establish a conflict prevention unit, peace mediation centre, or similar institution committed to fostering positive peace through diverse mechanisms, from grassroots movements to diplomacy.

3. Global Cooperation, Law, and Development

Issues

Global governance is hindered by shifting power dynamics, rising geopolitical tensions and polarisation, worsening economic inequities, declining trust in institutions, and protectionism. Some states, particularly powerful ones, are undermining the international rules-based system, and authoritarian practices are spreading across different continents. These factors limit coordinated action, weaken legal accountability, and reduce resources for equitable international development.

Actions

3.1. Work cooperatively, generously, and respectfully with other countries to address global challenges, taking an enabling approach to support countries that have less capability to contribute to solving global problems, including by:

3.1.1. Supporting the UN Agenda 2030 for Sustainable Development through the Sustainable Development Goals;

3.1.2. Investigating and supporting innovative ways of generating multilateral funding for multilateral programmes through, for example, charges on international flights and international currency transactions;

3.1.3. Cancelling unjust debt and providing unconditional debt relief that alleviates global inequality; and

3.1.4. Providing Official Development Assistance (ODA), in line with UN recommendations of 0.7% of Gross National Income, that:

3.1.4.1. Reflects best practice for reducing inequality- and poverty;

3.1.4.2. Avoids increasing the risk of indebtedness;

3.1.4.3. Prioritises programmes that have been proven to be successful, assessed against international standards;

3.1.4.4. Prioritises programmes that promote gender equality and those which support the education of girls and support sexual and reproductive health and rights, including heightened male responsibility;

3.1.4.5. Prioritises programmes in the Pacific that encourage connections to Tagata Moana diaspora communities in Aotearoa New Zealand;

3.1.4.6. Prioritises programmes that promote disability rights, such as those which support economic development, human rights and education; and

3.1.4.7. Is unconditional

3.2. Work proactively with overseas and international organisations, including Indigenous peoples, civil society organisations, and the private sector, to build a positive, collective response to global challenges.

3.3. Uphold and support the international rule of law by:

3.3.1. Supporting universal compulsory jurisdiction of the International Court of Justice (ICJ), and universal membership of the ICC;

3.3.2. Supporting measures to ensure impartial enforcement of decisions made by the ICJ and ICC;

3.3.3. Opposing any attempt by states to de-legitimise the international rule of law or politicise the ICC;

3.3.4. Opposing malicious attempts by international actors to destabilise international peace and order through disregard of international institutions and norms; and

3.3.5. Advocating for reform of the United Nations Security Council to support fair decision-making and transparent processes.

3.4. Support the self-determination of peoples, whether this involves devolution of political power, autonomy or independence, including by:

3.4.1. Advocating for an act of self-determination in the remaining non-self-governing territories under Chapter XI of the UN Charter, and respecting the wishes of the inhabitants in each case;

3.4.2. Advocating for a review of the status of non-self-governing territories that are not currently subject to UN monitoring, including in the Pacific; and

3.4.3. When territories express a desire for greater autonomy or full independence:

3.4.3.1. Supporting the principle of self-determination of peoples in all such cases, directly or through the UN, having regard also to the rights and responsibilities of the sovereign States involved; and

3.4.3.2. Introducing into the UN General Assembly a proposal for an expert study to be undertaken, under the auspices of the Secretary-General, concerning possible ways of dealing with issues of secession in a manner that ensures the maintenance of international peace and security and due respect for fundamental human rights, including the right of self-determination.

3.5. Support the right of all peoples to participate in political decision-making, including by advocating for:

3.5.1. Increasing the political participation of women, disabled people, Indigenous peoples, LGBTQI+ and other marginalised communities, particularly in the Pacific; and

3.5.2. Transparency and due process measures that ensure political decisions are made collectively.